

programmes reach underserved districts via the Aspirational Districts Programme, the NITI Aayog has helped bridge the gap between classroom and career. Under Skill India Mission, more than 15 million youth have been trained through initiatives that blend technology, industry linkages, and demand-driven curricula. It mapped sectoral needs and designed programmes that opened real economic doors for India's rural and urban youth alike.

In parallel, it championed a dynamic, inclusive labour market. It supported the rationalisation

monitored by the NITI Aayog, provided over 500 million Indians health insurance, while more than 150,000 health and wellness centres took primary care to the grassroots. Programmes targeted nutrition, maternal and child health, mental well-being, and noncommunicable diseases. The Covid-19 pandemic tested the resilience of India's health system like never before. In this crisis, the Aayog stood tall—partnering with the Ministry of Health and ICMR to model infection patterns, ensure equitable medical resource allocation, and

data, artificial intelligence, real-time dashboards, and rigorous monitoring frameworks, it ensured policies remain adaptive, accountable, and aligned with ground realities. Whether it was launching India's first SDG (Sustainable Development Goals) Index, guiding states on performance metrics, or using behavioural insights for policy design, the NITI Aayog brought scientific thinking to the heart of governance.

Its ability to coordinate across ministries and sectors has made it more than an advisory body—it has become the conscience-keeper of development. It has encouraged healthy competition among states through performance-based rankings, worked with civil society to amplify voices from the margins, and engaged global partners.

More than just achieving targets, the NITI Aayog has focused on creating systems that are sustainable, inclusive, and future-ready. Its commitment to the SDGs is evident in every initiative—from clean energy transitions to green mobility, from digital public infrastructure to gender equity in workspaces.

India's rise as a knowledge economy is no longer a distant dream—it is a work in progress. What the NITI Aayog has done is elevate the discourse around development, reminding us that true progress is measured by the strength, health, and dignity of its people. In doing so, it has become more than a think tank. It has become the pulse of a young, aspiring India—an India that dreams, dares, and does. And at the heart of this story is the quiet confidence that when you invest in people, you build not just a better economy, but a better nation. **BT**

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of 44 central labour laws into four simplified codes—on wages, social security, industrial relations, and occupational safety. These reforms balanced employer flexibility with worker protection, particularly benefiting informal sector workers who make up the majority of India's workforce. By simplifying compliance and encouraging formalisation, the workplace became not only more productive but also more humane.

Healthcare, often seen as a cost, was reframed as an investment. The NITI Aayog helped engineer the shift from reactive treatment to proactive wellness. The Ayushman Bharat scheme, backed and

roll out platforms like eSanjeevani for telemedicine.

Beyond these, the NITI Aayog has been a lighthouse for entrepreneurship and innovation. Programmes like Start-Up India, Stand-Up India, and the Atal Innovation Mission created a fertile ecosystem for ideas to flourish. Thousands of start-ups are thriving today because they had policy support, incubation, and mentorship at crucial stages. These are not just businesses; they are job creators and problem solvers.

But perhaps its greatest achievement lies in how it has institutionalised a culture of evidence-based policymaking. By leveraging big

Views are personal